

TeacherGuide2-Bookkeeping-Instructor

TEACHER'S GUIDE — Bookkeeping & Accounts

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TEACHING BOOKKEEPING TO NON-ACCOUNTANTS

Most students fear numbers. Your first job is to remove that fear.

Opening Statement for Day 1: > “Bookkeeping is not complicated maths. It is organised common sense. If you know how to count your market money, you already understand bookkeeping.”

KEY TEACHING APPROACHES

Use Real Zimbabwe Examples Always

- Don't use “Company XYZ” — use “Mama Chipo's tuckshop in Mbare”
- Don't use dollars abstractly — use “a \$2 bread, a \$3.50 cooking oil”
- Students connect emotionally to examples they recognise

The Wallet Analogy (teaches debit/credit instantly)

“Money coming INTO your wallet = a debit (you receive it). Money going OUT of your wallet = a credit (you give it away). In bookkeeping, every transaction has TWO sides — one side gains, one side loses.”

Cash Book Introduction

Before showing the Cash Book template, ask: > “How do you keep track of your money at home?” Students will describe mental notes, phone notes, written lists. > “A Cash Book is just that — but organised, so you can prove every transaction.”

WEEK-BY-WEEK NOTES

Week 1 — Focus on the Cash Book

- Day 1: Show what a Cash Book looks like. Fill one in together as a class.
- Day 2: Students fill in their own Cash Book from a list of transactions you provide
- Day 3: Introduce source documents — receipt, invoice, delivery note
- Day 4: Match source documents to Cash Book entries
- Day 5: Running balance exercise — track daily opening/closing balance

Week 2 — Ledger & Double Entry

This is the hardest week. Go slowly. - Use the T-account drawing on the board for EVERY example - Repeat the debit/credit rule every single lesson until automatic - The Trial Balance is satisfying when it balances — use that “aha moment”

Week 3 — Financial Statements

- Income Statement: “Revenue - Expenses = Profit. Simple.”
- Balance Sheet: “What we OWN minus what we OWE = our Net Worth”
- Bank reconciliation: use a real-looking bank statement printout

Week 4 — Zimbabwe Specific

- ZIMRA: bring a printed ZIMRA tax form and walk through it
- NSSA: calculate contributions for 3 fictional employees together
- Petty cash: students love this — it feels manageable and real

COMMON STUDENT ERRORS TO WATCH

Error	How to Correct
Confusing debit and credit	Repeat the wallet analogy every day for a week
Not balancing the Trial Balance	Check individual ledger accounts one by one
Mixing personal and business expenses	Emphasise: “Your tuckshop money is NOT your pocket money”
Wrong VAT calculations	Practice 15% VAT calculations daily as a warm-up